

# Tobias Treppmann

Design systems lead who builds the enforcement, not just the library — because a shared system is only as real as what the build refuses

## CONTACT

### LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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### PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/telekom

### LINKEDIN

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## EDUCATION

### M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA  
2022 – 2026

### Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland  
2003 – 2007

## LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

## ONGOING

### Independent Consultant

*Oratio&Co*

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

## PROFILE

I build design systems that hold when nobody is watching. At Bibel TV the tokens ship as an API: three tiers, one commit reaching Figma, Android and web. Six checks run in CI and refuse work that leaves the system, and over a library believed clean they surfaced 32 off-system values. The standard lives in the build rather than in a review, which is why it survives a handoff to an external engineering agency. Before that, design systems at Ninox and Datameer, and accessibility audited under the EU Accessibility Act across a whole platform.

## EXPERIENCE

### Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

*Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency)* Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Token architecture in three tiers — global primitives, then semantic, then component, built with Style Dictionary on DTCG and synced live to Figma and Android. One commit propagates to every platform. Primitives are fixed, semantics are the contract, and component tokens are where a product team gets room.
- A system the build enforces — six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI. Two reject what an AI assistant produces. One is a token reference that does not resolve, the other a color hardcoded into a component. Both compile and render. Over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values.
- Enablement designed into the format — the token vocabulary is handed to an assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so the compliant path is also the fast one. The system reports its own gaps, eight so far, in the order people hit them.
- A color engine, and the tool that configures it — k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight. Text is validated against base with the WCAG algorithm until the pair passes. Every threshold is a dial in the config tool rather than a commit.
- Agentic engineering introduced from zero — prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android. Around 70% of the AI-generated code reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours.

### Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

*Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US)* Berlin, Germany

- Design-system governance as a working group — shared across four designers and engineering, with an escalation path for the calls that could not be settled in the group. Motion belonged to the system too, as custom easing curves rather than per-screen animation.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment run with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning instead of receiving finished decisions. Senior Leadership Team throughout, which is where design strategy got aligned to business goals rather than argued for afterwards.
- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — from July to October 2023 I held Product Design and Product together. Design was five, split between product design and UX writing, including a design lead. Product was three product managers and a data scientist. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product permanently. Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship.

### Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

*ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH)* Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Accessibility audited past our own front door — we audited the ChurchDesk website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance. The standard had to hold in output produced by parish staff, not by specialists.
- Accessibility shipped under regulation — AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries. Screen-reader semantics and ARIA as standing practice.
- Booking capability — the architecture call I defended through the build. The internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered a capability embedded in the platform instead, general enough to carry the most-requested use cases. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, and it then shipped to every customer.

### Director of Design

2016 – 2021

*Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers)* Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Component behavior and specs across the library — I defined how components behaved and what they promised, and the UI designers executed the visual system. Motion was part of it, as custom easing curves. I led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, a functional head trading scope with product and engineering counterparts.
- Five years of data-dense enterprise interfaces — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers.

### Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

*Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE)* Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team of a listed group to productize its service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog aligned to business and product goals. Ran design-thinking training for that leadership team and for the service teams.

## EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

Member, Mentor Advisory Board · *The UX School* · 2017 – 2018 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

## SKILLS

### Design Systems and Token Architecture

DTCG tokens in three tiers at Bibel TV, from global primitives through semantic to component, with Style Dictionary and live sync to Figma and Android · One commit propagates to every platform · Storybook as the source of truth with a prototyping layer on top · Shared governance across four designers and engineering at Ninox, with an escalation path · Component behavior and specs across the Datameer library, where the UI designers executed the visual system · Motion carried as custom easing curves rather than per-screen animation

### Tools, Governance and Workflows

Six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI and refuse off-system work · They reject a reference to a token that does not exist and a color, size or duration hardcoded into a component · Both compile and render, so neither is caught by tests or review · 32 off-system values identified in a library believed clean after two cleanup passes · The system reports its own token gaps, eight so far, in the order people hit them · New technologies integrated into the design workflow rather than trialed beside it, which is how the improvement holds

### Design Strategy Aligned to Business Goals

Senior Leadership Team at Ninox, where design strategy was set alongside product and engineering rather than argued for afterwards · Partnered with Hypoport's executive team to productize the service organization of a listed group · The ChurchDesk internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered an embedded platform capability instead, general enough to carry the most-requested use cases · Strategic thinking that starts from what the business is trying to do and works back to the system

### Accessibility and Inclusive Design

At ChurchDesk we audited our own website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance · That second half is the harder one, because the standard has to hold in output produced by parish staff rather than by specialists · Screen-reader semantics and ARIA as standing practice across three companies — Bibel TV, ChurchDesk and Ninox · AI alt-text generation shipped for EU accessibility compliance, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries · WCAG contrast validated inside the color engine rather than checked afterwards, in light and dark, so no theme ships failing

### Influence Without a Reporting Line

The Bibel TV standard is enforced by the build and holds across a handoff to an external engineering agency · Design-system governance run as a cross-functional working group at Ninox · Stakeholder relationships managed and harmonized across Spreadshirt's matrix organization of 200-plus people · Design-thinking training run for Hypoport's executive team and its service teams

### Mentoring and Enablement

Ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, reviewing and critiquing designers' work and portfolios · Two years mentoring at the Interaction Design Foundation · Mentor advisory board at The UX School · Coached the Ninox design lead through a strained engineering relationship · Hired two, promoted two · The token vocabulary handed to an assistant as an enumerated list, so the compliant path is the fast one

### Interaction, Visual and Systems Design

A color engine built at Bibel TV and live in production, with k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB so themes carry even perceptual weight · The configuration tool that tunes every threshold as a dial rather than a commit · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store · Fifteen years of interface work, five of them on data-dense enterprise interfaces

### Technical Understanding

Prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android · Around 70% of the AI-generated code reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours · The handoff crosses a company boundary to an external engineering agency and holds anyway · Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools · Android/Kotlin, SwiftUI, React and web